

JOCHEM VANAGT

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EDUCATION

2022 – 2026	Ph.D. in Political Science	KU LEUVEN & UNIVERSITY OF ANTWERP, BELGIUM
	– Dissertation: <i>Beyond the Two-Party Divide: How Coalition Dynamics and Ideological Orientations Redefine Affective Polarization in Europe</i>. Open-Access Version – Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Stefaan Walgrave (University of Antwerp), Prof. Dr. Ellen Claes (KU Leuven), Dr. Luana Russo (Maastricht University)	
03.2026 – 05.2026	Visiting Researcher	AARHUS UNIVERSITY, DENMARK
03.2024 – 05.2024	Visiting Researcher	UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA, AUSTRIA
2020 – 2022	M.Sc. (research) in European Studies	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	– Distinction: <i>Highest Distinction</i> (GPA: 88%) – Thesis title: <i>For Richer or For Poorer, Polarisation Affects Us All: A Two-Stage Comparative Analysis of the Economic Foundations of Affective Polarisation in Europe</i> (grade: 9/10) – Specialisations: <u>Quantitative Methodology</u>, Survey Research Design, Governance & Representation	
2017 – 2020	B.Sc. in Medicine	ANTWERP UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM
	– Distinction: <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> (GPA: 77%) – Medical internships: human genetics, cardiology, gastroenterology – Summer courses: genetic engineering (Aarhus University, Denmark), international business and political science (King's College London, United Kingdom), macro-economics and financial investment (Maastricht University, Netherlands)	

RESEARCH

Research Fields: Political Behaviour, Comparative Politics, Political Psychology

Research Interests: Affective Polarisation, Partisanship, Radical-Right Support, Political Involvement, Democratic Support [†]

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- (5) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2025) Partisan Affect and Political Tolerance in the Context of Shifting Norms: The Effect of Coalition Signals towards the Radical Right. *Journal of European Public Policy*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2025.2558980>
- (4) **Vanagt, J.**[†] & Kollberg, M.[†] (2025) United in Success, Fragmented in Failure: The Moderating Effect of Perceived Government Performance on Affective Polarisation between Coalition Partners. *European Journal of Political Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.70012>
- (3) **Vanagt, J.** & Russo, L. (2024) The Economic Divide That Isn't: A Comparative Study on Economic Hardship and Affective Polarisation. *Research & Politics*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680241292410>
- (2) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2024) Affective Polarization Among Radical-Right Supporters: Dislike Differentiation and Democratic Support. *Politics and Governance*. <https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.8531>
- (1) **Vanagt, J.** (2024) Appraising Measurements of Affective Polarisation in Multiparty Systems: Comparative Insights from the Low Countries. *Politics of the Low Countries*, 6(3), 96-116. <https://doi.org/10.5553/PLC/.000068>.

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WORK IN PROGRESS

- (5) Reversing Radical-Right Normalization: Evidence from a Natural Quasi-Experiment, *with Laura Jacobs, Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet*
- (4) Public support for the cordon sanitaire in Belgium. Exploring the impact of institutionalization, *with Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet, Laura Jacobs*
- (3) Rethinking Political Identity in Europe: Partisan and Ideological Attachment in Times of Affective Polarization, *with Luana Russo*
- (2) Let's (Not) Disagree: How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarisation, *with Luana Russo*
- (1) The Low Countries (Belgium & the Netherlands): Balancing National Diversity with Supranational Integration. In T. D. Lancaster (Ed.), *Comparative European Politics*. Taylor & Francis Group, *with Bjarn Eck*

METHODS TRAINING & SUMMER/WINTER SCHOOLS

2026	Winter school "Introduction to A.I. and Machine Learning" Dr. Dariush Salami	AALTO UNIVERSITY, FINLAND
2024	Summer school "Democratic Decline and Resilience" Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet	UNIVERSITY OF MONTRÉAL, CANADA
2023	PhD course "Political Psychology" Prof. Dr. Hanna Bäck and Prof. Dr. Magnus Lindén	LUND UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN
	Summer school "Surveying Hard-To-Reach Populations" Dr. Alessandra Gaia	UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM
	Summer school "Electoral Democracy in Danger?" Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet	SCIENCES PO PARIS, FRANCE
	Workshop "Experimental Methods" Prof. Dr. Bert Bakker	GHENT UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM
2022	Workshop "Statistical Power Analysis" Dr. Niklas Johannes	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
	Summer school "Causal Inference and Experiments" Prof. Dr. Ryan T. Moore	UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM
	Workshop "Applied Multiple Imputation"	GESIS, GERMANY
	Winter school "Multilevel Structural Equation Modelling" Prof. Dr. Bruno Castanho Silva	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM

TEACHING & ADVISING

2025	Public Speaker & Science Communicator Various lectures to general public on <i>Causes and Consequences of Ideological Differences and Emotions in Politics</i>	BELGIUM
2023 – 2025	Tutor & Teaching Assistant Course on <i>European Integration</i> by Prof. Dr. Peter Bursens Course on <i>International Relations</i> by Prof. Dr. Dirk de Bièvre Course on <i>Political Behavior</i> by Prof. Dr. Peter Thijssen	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM

2024	Guest Lecturer Guest lecture on <i>Affective Polarisation in the U.S. and Europe</i>	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM
	Keynote Speaker Keynote on <i>The Role of Affective Polarisation and Radical Partisanship in the 2024 US Elections</i> at the <i>UAntwerpen American Election Night Event</i>	UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM
2022 – 2024	Thesis Advisor 3 master students	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
2022	Tutor Bachelor course <i>Introduction to Quantitative Methods</i>	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
2021 – 2022	Student Assistant Supervisor Supervising 2 bachelor students in interdisciplinary research project with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021 – 2022	Research Assistant Project planning, data collection (N = 2,174) and analysis with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham Data collection and coding for Dr. Anna Herranz-Surrallés	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
2021 – 2022	Research Intern Data harmonisation and data documentation for the International Social Survey Programme and Horizon-funded <i>COORDINATE</i> project	GESIS, GERMANY

MEDIA

2026	News article in <i>Het Laatste Nieuws</i> on doctoral dissertation Doctoral researcher examines polarisation in Europe	
2025	News article in <i>Kleine Zeitung</i> on joint research Why the “firewall” against the far right is so fragile Blog piece in <i>The Loop ECPR’s Political Science Blog</i> Coalition governments reduce partisan animosity—but only if they perform well	
2024	Opinion piece in <i>De Tijd</i> Does polarisation threaten to paralyse Europa just like in the US? Interview in <i>De Ochtend</i> , Radio 1 (VRT) How consequential is ‘affective’ polarisation in Belgium? News article in <i>De Morgen</i> on joint research Radical-right voters are especially despised, but that matters little to them Blog post in <i>SWAY KU Leuven</i> Affective polarisation and the Belgian elections on 9 June 2024 Interview by <i>Belga</i> on affective polarisation in Belgium Published in <i>Télésambre</i> , <i>7sur7</i> , <i>Grenz-Echo</i> , and <i>BRF Nachrichten</i>	
2023	Blog piece in <i>Fondation Maison des Science de l’Homme</i> and <i>Montreal Centre for International Studies</i> How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarization	

SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

2024 – 2025	Reviewer for European Journal of Political Research, Government and Opposition, Swiss Political Science Review, Electoral Studies
2023 – 2024	Panel Chair ECPR General Conference 2023, ECPR General Conference 2024
2023 – 2024	Co-Developer Voting Advice Application for the 2024 Belgian Elections Filled out over 6 million times Winner of the 2025 University of Antwerp Prize for Societal Engagement

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

2026	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	GHENT UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM
2025	APSA Annual Meeting	VANCOUVER, CANADA
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	GRONINGEN UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	ECPR Joint Sessions	PRAGUE, CZECHIA
2024	ECPR General Conference	UNIVERSITY COLLEGE DUBLIN, IRELAND
	EPSA 14 th Annual Conference	COLOGNE, GERMANY
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
2023	Symposium on Affective Polarisation	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	ECPR General Conference	CHARLES UNIVERSITY, CZECHIA
	EPSA 13 th Annual Conference	GLASGOW, UNITED KINGDOM
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM
2022	ECPR General Conference	UNIVERSITY OF INNSBRUCK, AUSTRIA
	UACES Graduate Forum Conference	MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries	RADBOUD UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Statistical software	STATA (proficient), R (proficient), SPSS (intermediate), Python (basic)
Programmes	Qualtrics (survey and experimental design), LaTeX, Git/Gitlab
Languages	Dutch (native), English (CEFR C2), German (CEFR C1+), Danish (CEFR C1), French (CEFR B2)